

A FATHER WHO CARED

Mark 5:21-24 (NKJV) *“Now when Jesus had crossed over again by boat to the other side, a great multitude gathered to Him; and He was by the sea. 22 And behold, one of the rulers of the synagogue came, Jairus by name. And when he saw Him, he fell at His feet 23 and begged Him earnestly, saying, "My little daughter lies at the point of death. Come and lay Your hands on her, that she may be healed, and she will live." 24 So Jesus went with him, and a great multitude followed Him and thronged Him.”*

Mark 5:35-43 (NKJV) *“While He was still speaking, some came from the ruler of the synagogue’s house who said, "Your daughter is dead. Why trouble the Teacher any further?" 36 As soon as Jesus heard the word that was spoken, He said to the ruler of the synagogue, "Do not be afraid; only believe." 37 And He permitted no one to follow Him except Peter, James, and John, the brother of James. 38 Then He came to the house of the ruler of the synagogue, and saw a tumult and those who wept and wailed loudly. 39 When He came in, He said to them, "Why make this commotion and weep? The child is not dead,*

but sleeping." 40 And they ridiculed Him. But when He had put them all outside, He took the father and the mother of the child, and those who were with Him, and entered where the child was lying. 41 Then He took the child by the hand, and said to her, "Little girl, I say to you, arise." 42 Immediately the girl arose and walked, for she was twelve years of age. And they were overcome with great amazement. 43 But He commanded them strictly that no one should know it, and said that something should be given her to eat."

INTRO: One of the first things I noticed about this story is the fact that this father was extremely attentive to his family. Every father has a responsibility of being a present, active participant in the life of his family. One of the names used to describe our God is "Jehovah Shammah", THE GOD WHO IS THERE,

Many homes in America are suffering from the phantom father syndrome. Absentee fatherhood does not just affect single parent homes; oftentimes the father becomes an absentee as a result of the pursuit of things. Trust me dads, your children need you more than they need the things you can provide.

In this culture millions of men have fathered children, and simply walked away from the family! Being a sperm donor does not make a man a father!

To carry the title of father is more than the result of a passionate relationship, it also carries with it great responsibilities.

Recent reports tell us: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME) **Because of a lack of father figures in the home over the past 30 years this country has witnessed a:**

- 550% increase in violent crime
- 400% increase in illegitimate births
- 200% increase in teen pregnancies
- 300% increase in teen suicide
- More than 70% of all juveniles in state reform institutions come from fatherless homes

The home needs more than a man in the house, it needs a father!

Jairus was a presiding elder of the synagogue. As the presiding elder of the Synagogue he was responsible for the order of all religious services which occurred in Capernaum.

His position made him one of the most prominent men of the community and congregation. Jairus was a man with a high social position, a man known among the people, a man of prestige and power. As a result, he was a very busy man attending to a hectic schedule. Yet he was a man who made time for his family.

Jairus was also a man with a very desperate need! His little girl, the apple of his eye, was at the point of death!

I want us to look at three things concerning Jairus...

I. HE SOUGHT JESUS OUT...

A. Notice, Jairus sought Jesus out for himself! He did not delegate this responsibility to his wife; family members; co-workers; or underlings.

When a man steps into the role of a father whether from a biological sense or through marrying someone who already has children he is to take upon himself all the responsibilities of fatherhood which are given to him by the Heavenly Father!

Paul tells us in [Ephesians 6:4](#) (KJV) “*And, ye*

fathers, provoke not your children to wrath: but bring them up in the nurture and admonition of the Lord.” (AMP) “Fathers do not irritate and provoke your children anger; do not exasperate them to resentment; rear them tenderly in the training, discipline, council, and admonition of the Lord.”

B. As a father, we are to do the following things with regard to our children: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Dedicate our children to God, not just with a ceremony but with our words and actions!
- Teach our children to fear the Lord; to turn away from evil; and to love righteousness!
- Protect our children from ungodly influences!
- Establish our children in a proper house of worship!
- Instruct our children in the importance of salvation by grace and the Baptism in the Holy Spirit!

Always remember they will most likely follow what they see being modeled!

C. Jairus came to Jesus himself seeking the

welfare of his family! Sir, don't be guilty of sending your family to church, bring them! Don't allow the mantle of spiritual responsibility to fall on the shoulders of your wife, be the man God has called you to be and step up to the plate and knock it out of the park!

D. While all eyes were upon Jairus he knelt humbly in the presence of Jesus, pleading with Him to come to his house and heal his daughter! Sir, when the situation becomes desperate enough you will forget about who you are... All dignity and pride will go out the window... You will seek Jesus out... Do you really want to wait until desperation comes to your home?

II. HE WELCOMED CHRIST INTO HIS HOME...

A. Jairus had the respect of most of the people in this crowd. They looked up to him; he was a man of great influence.

To many of the folks who respected Jairus, Jesus was nothing more than a hypocrite who was a friend of sinners! To them He was a winebibber and a raving maniac who had overestimated His own worth! In their opinion, the work he did was by the power of the devil!

It was in this atmosphere that **Jairus approached Jesus publicly inviting Him to enter his home for the purpose of healing his little girl!**

B. A Christian home is of tremendous value to the children who live there. Our world needs more Christian homes! **A Christian home is a place where Christ has been invited to reside!** This invitation should be extended by the head of the home! Why is it so important for Christ to reside at our house? **Psalms 127:1 (KJV)** ***“Except the LORD build the house, they labor in vain that build it: except the LORD keep the city, the watchman waketh but in vain.”***

C. Think back with me to the first Passover. Who was responsible for placing the blood on the door? The Father, the head of the home! The assignment of that responsibility cannot be escaped!

D. When Christ entered the home of Jairus He alone chose who was to stay and who was to go! Who belonged and who did not belong! He took the authority in Jairus' home!

Dad's I want to ask you this question: Are you letting him have this kind of authority in your

home? Have you given Him permission to permit that which he desires, and get rid of that which does not belong?

III. HE PUBLICLY EXPRESSED HIS LOVE FOR HIS DAUGHTER...

A. When Jairus' daughter became sick his work in the Synagogue became secondary! He discovered that his commitment to his family was much more important than his work at the church!

He discovered that his standing in the community and even his reputation was less important than the well being of his family!

It is a sad that it often takes a tragedy in the family for some dad's to determine what is really important in life! (Susan's correction – The church will get another pastor but your children will never have another father!)

What would make a man of such stature ignore the tide of public opinion and publicly seek out the help of a person which most people considered to be a heretic?

What would make a man leave the bedside of a dying daughter to seek out a Jewish Teacher

who had a publicity problem?

What would compel Jairus to fall down at Jesus' feet and cry out ***"I beg you, please come?"***

Love! He loved his daughter, and this love said I will do whatever is necessary... I will go anywhere... I will pay any price... To see that she is made whole!

(HUMAN VIDEO)

The Bible does not say how long this girl lived... She may have lived to be a hundred for all we know but I can assure you that there was not a day that went by, that this girl didn't know--I'm alive today because of my daddy's love for me!

B. Hear me, dad's listen very closely—A father's love is not giving a child all they ask for; a room full of toys; a closet full of clothes; a large allowance!

A father's love is the genuine care for the welfare of a child! (Physically, spiritually, and educationally)

At times a father must sit a child down, looking them in the eye and say, *“we are Christian's, we serve Jesus and because of that there are some things I will allow and things I will not allow; things we will do and things we will not do!”*

C. I am quite sure Jairus' daughter did not understand the absence of her father but he made a decision to seek Jesus so his daughter would have a chance at life!

(LEAVE THIS ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE END OF THE SERVICE) *We must seek Jesus because it is in the best interest of our family both now and eternally!*

CONCLUSION:

- Pray for fathers
- Fathers of unsaved children
- Wives whose husbands are not saved
- Single parents